



LAS 6292: Data Collection and Management

Emilio M. Bruna

November 15, 2026

Table of Contents

Introduction	1
I. Course Topics	2
1. Naming Conventions	3
1.1. Introduction	3
1.2. How to name your files	3
1.3. Tools & Resources	4
2. File Organization	5
2.1. File Organization - Electronic	5
2.2. Example: Project Based Organization	5
2.3. File Organization - Physical	6
2.4. Documentation	6
3. Data Storage & Backup	7
3.1. What is backup?	7
3.2. Tools & Resources	11
3.3. Reading and Sources	14
4. Data Organization in Spreadsheets	15
4.1. Things to remember when organizing Data in Spreadsheets	15
4.2. Tools & Tutorials	16
4.3. Reading and Sources	16
5. Reproducible Data Cleanup with R	17
5.1. Set up an RStudio Project and install the relevant packages	17
5.2. Gather the Raw Data to be corrected	17
5.3. <i>Take your data from messy to clean in these 6 steps:</i>	17
5.4. Tools & Resources	19
5.5. Additional (interesting) Reading	19
6. QA/QC: Reducing Error Entry, Finding and Correcting Errors	21
6.1. Reducing errors when entering data	21
6.2. R Packages for Data QA/QC	22
6.3. Readings & Sources	23
7. Class Outline: QA/QC 2 - Open Refine	24
7.1. OpenRefine	24
7.2. OpenRefine Tutorials	24

Table of Contents

7.3. GREL Cheatsheets	24
7.4. R Tools for OpenRefine	25
8. Metadata	26
8.1. What are Metdatadata?	26
8.2. Best practices for preparing metadata	26
8.3. Discipline-specific metadata standards	27
8.4. Metadata templates	27
8.5. Tools for creating machine-readable metadata	28
8.6. Metadata Dictionaries	28
8.7. Organizations developing metadata standards and schema	28
9. Data Management Plans	29
9.1. Reminder: What is a DMP?	29
9.2. Why do one?	29
9.3. What are the components of a DMP?	29
9.4. Start Here	30
9.5. What should go in my DMP?	30
9.6. Sample DMPs	30
9.7. DMP Details	31
9.8. REMINDER	34
9.9. Resources	34
10. Some sample DMPs	35
11. Additional resources to help prepare your DMP	36
12. Efficient Data Collection	37
12.1. Introduction	37
12.2. Forms	37
12.3. Checklists	38
12.4. Tools, & Resources	38
12.5. Assigned Readings & Videos	39
13. Transcription & Translation	41
13.1. Transcription	41
13.2. Translation	45
13.3. Sources & Additional Readings	46
14. Paperless Data Collection	47
14.1. Recommended Platform: EpiCollect	47
14.2. Paid platforms for paperless data collection	47
14.3. Useful smartphone apps for fieldwork	47
14.4. Google Sheets	47
14.5. Mobile Form Design	48
14.6. Barcode Scanner Apps	48
14.7. Photos as Paperless Data Collection	48
14.8. DIY	48
14.9. Additional Reading	48

15. Automated Data Collection & Extraction	50
15.1. APIs	51
15.2. Optical Character Recognition	51
15.3. Extracting tables from images with R	52
15.4. Extracting Data from Published Figures	52
15.5. Text Mining	52
15.6. Collecting & Processing data from the Web of Science and Scopus	53
15.7. Scraping websites	53
15.8. Cell Phone Data	53
15.9. Social Media Data	54
15.10 Automated Image Analysis	54
15.11 Wearable Devices & RFID tags	54
15.12 Building automated data collectors	55
15.13 Online data archives	55
16. Ethics & Legal Compliance	57
16.1. Data/Research Ethics & Compliance for UF Researchers	57
16.2. Privacy Laws	57
16.3. Anonymizing Data	57
16.4. Working with Indigenous Communities	58
16.5. Data Collection, Privacy, and Gender	58
16.6. Emerging issues resulting from technological advancements	58
16.7. Text mining, copyright, and the law	59
16.8. Ethics of Data Sharing	59
II. Individual Projects	60
17. Assignments Overview	61
17.1. Weekly In-class activities	61
17.2. Reproducible Data Organization Project	61
17.3. Thesis Research DMP	61
III. Useful Resources	62
18. Useful resources for Data Collection & Management	63
18.1. R Programming	63
18.2. Specific Data Cleaning and Management Problems	64
18.3. Advanced R Packages for Data Management	64
18.4. Data Visualization	64
18.5. Slide & Presentations	65
18.6. Documents & Reports	65
18.7. Discipline-specific R Resources	65
18.8. Data Archives	65
18.9. Disposal & Destruction of Records	65
18.10 Non-R software & tools	66
19. Class Slides	67

Introduction

This book is a manual for students in LAS 6292: Data Collection & Management. The course is designed for graduate students from any discipline – social sciences, humanities, biophysical sciences – and at all stages of their graduate program. It is an introduction to methods for collecting, organizing, managing, and visualizing both qualitative and quantitative data. Students will gain hands-on experience with best practices and tools.

- 🗨 Describe the different types of research data & the research data life-cycle
- ❓ Explain the need for and benefits of data management and sharing
- 📁 Describe and implement best practices for data collection, storage, management, and sharing
- 🔍 Find, download, and analyze publicly available data from repositories
- ✔ Carry out simple and reproducible data corrections and dataset organization
- 🏛 Describe public policies and agency requirements for data management and sharing
- ⚖ Articulate the major legal & ethical issues regarding the data collection, use, and storage
- 📁 Create and Implement Data Management Plans in funder-specific formats
- ✂ Identify and properly use tools for more efficient and secure data collection in the field

💡 Citation

This guide is a [Quarto Book](#) hosted on the [Bruna Lab's Github site](#). Please suggest edits to the text, missing resources, or make suggestions for improvement either by [pull request](#) or by [posting an issue](#) on the course book's repository. For more information and tutorials for doing so see the [Github documentation](#).

Part I.

Course Topics

1. Naming Conventions

1.1. Introduction

The first (and easiest) way to get started organizing your data is to use a simple, clear, and consistent system for naming your files (i.e., a “naming convention”). Using a well-thought out naming convention has a number of important benefits:

- Files will be easier to find
- You won’t have to open files to see what they are
- Files are easier to sort
- Files are easier to share with collaborators (and for collaborators to use)
- It helps prevent accidentally overwriting or deleting files

1.2. How to name your files

Your file names should:

Tell you about the contents of the file and allow you to uniquely identify it. For instance (compare 'data 1998' vs 'survey data' vs 'survey data 1998' vs 'small mammal survey data 1998'). You can use things like the an acronym for the project, abbreviation for the study, location where collected, the name of the investigator, the year or month when collected, the type of data type, etc.

Be as short as possible. Many database systems (like MS One Drive) have limits on file name length. Use a max of 25 characters, and aim for less than that.

Avoid using special characters and spaces Don’t use characters like \$ % ^ & # | : . This is really important because software, automated data processing tools, web browsers, and computer operating systems use spaces and special characters for dividing up (parsing) strings of text, as well as other processes.

Start with letters, never numbers. Using numbers at the start of file names can lead to problems when they are read into stats software and other programs. Instead of '2020_survey_responses' use 'survey_responses_2020'

Help you quickly sort files chronologically or numerically. Dates are very useful in file names because they can help identify the most recent files easily. You can *not* rely on the file date associated with the file on the computer! However, it is really important to use a clear format for dates, especially if collaborating internationally. I learned the hard way that not everyone reads 'census_data_3-4-2018' the same way I do, so I started using 'census_data_4march2018'. However, even this isn’t ideal because of how it sorts things in a folder. Now I now use this format: 'file_name_YYYYMMDD' ('census_data_20180403').

1. Naming Conventions

You can also use `file_name_YYYY-MM-DD`. This is based on the international format for dates and times ([ISO 8601](#)). In addition to the benefit of sorting more easily, you'll never have to use the the dreaded `'____.final.docx'` and `'____.actual_final.docx'` in your file names ever again...you'll always know which is the last one. If the files don't require a date, but you want to maintain a sequence, use leading zeros to maintain sort order. 7 and 701 don't sort the way you expect them to, so use 007 and 701.

Use a consistent method of dealing with spaces and letter case. . For a the spreadsheet with responses to a survey by 5 different people, don't use `'survey responses Florida'`. Instead use (i) `'survey_responses_florida'` or (ii) `'SurveyResponsesFlorida'`. Try to avoid mixing the two (e.g., `'survey_responses_Florida'`). By the way, (i) is known as **pothole** and (ii) is known as **camel**. Personally, I prefer pothole name is better because of it is easier to read and you never to remember what words get capitalized (because none of the do). Use underscore (`_`) or dashes (`-`) to separate meaningful parts of file names.

Once you have a system, write it down, print it out, and put it up somewhere you can easily refer to it. Remember -whenever possible make the names simple, informative, and unique. If you collected survey data and behavioral data in 2017, don't call them both `data_2017` even if they are in different folders. Call one `'behavior_obs_2017'` and the other `'survey_responses_2017'`).

Simple names also help you avoid problems with “system and software portability” - you might be working on a Mac but your collaborators are working on Linux or Windows, and the software made for each can read file names in different ways. File names that are simple, lower-case, and have no special characters are less software- and platform-dependent.

1.3. Tools & Resources

Best Practices & Conventions for Naming Files

- [Smithsonian Library](#)
- [UF Library](#) (*bottom of the page*)
- [Stanford Library](#)

Tutorials and Tools for Bulk Renaming of Files

- Batch Renaming of Files in Windows: [Post](#)
- Batch Renaming of Files in MacOS: [Post 1](#), [Post 2](#)
- [Adobe Bridge](#) (*a powerful “asset manager” used to organize collections and edit metadata*)
- [Renamer](#) (macOS)
- [Renamer Lite](#)
- [Bulk Rename](#) (Windows)
- [Rename Master](#) (Windows)
- [Ant Renamer](#)

2. File Organization

2.1. File Organization - Electronic

There aren't really "rules" about how to organize your files, but I think the best way to organize is to think in terms of "projects". Of course, how you define a "project" is sometimes tough...is the PhD the 'Project' or is each chapter of the dissertation a 'Project'? You'll have to give this some thought and think of a system that works for you. That said...**I like 'Project' based organization for two main reasons:**

First, it pushes you to think in terms of outcomes: 'projects' lead to 'products' (e.g., paper, report, grant proposal). This helps you think more clearly about what data need to be collected and the analyses that need to be done. If the data aren't for a new project, and it's not clear to you if or how the data fit into a pre-existing project, then are you sure you need to spend time, effort, and money collecting them?

Second, project-based organization focuses on the individual steps and components that take a project from start-to-finish: planning your data collection, data gathering and clean-up, analysis, presentation, and data archiving.

2.2. Example: Project Based Organization

A project-based organization scheme for a master's thesis might look something like this:

1. Top Folder: emb_masters_thesis
2. Sub-folder 1: Chapter1_lit_review
3. Nested Folders and Subfolders for:
 - Plans for Data Collection & Management
 - DMP
 - plans for storage and backup
 - data
 - raw data
 - clean data
 - metadata
 - analyses
 - intermediate outputs from analyses
 - final outputs from analyses
 - presentation (e.g., masters_ch1_text or ch1_slides)
 - data archiving

2. File Organization

You can have one of these for each thesis chapter. Note that some (DMP, plans for storage and backup) might be better placed one folder up in the `emb_master_thesis` folder

But what if I will be using the same data for multiple chapters or papers? This is a great questions, and there are several options. One would be to include both chapters in the same folder, each with its own subfolder (manuscript 1, manuscript 2). The other would be to have each as a separate project, and pull the data in from the online archive where you deposited the data (or folder where the data are stored). As you can probably guess, I think #2 is better because I think of each paper as a different project.

2.3. File Organization - Physical

Whenever possible I try to organize physical records and archives in the same way as digital ones: in a single box, file folder, cabinet, etc.** try to set it up so that you go to one place for everything related to a project. Of course, you can't always do that because specimens go to museums or stay in an archive...but you can keep the information on how to *find* the originals there. Don't forget to include copies of the survey, data sheets, etc., as well as maps or other such resources.

Correspondence is a bit more complicated. You can keep notes - electronic or paper - in the relevant folder. But one thing that has gotten complicated is email correspondence regarding projects, manuscripts, etc. Printing seems like a huge waste of paper, and yet if critical it might be worth doing. Other wise keep an email folder for each project as well - with the same name as the electronic version so you can easily find email correspondence related to each project.

2.4. Documentation

Write it down. Prepare a file documenting your data organization structure so you can share it with team members (or look at it years later when looking for something). These can be 'README.txt' files as needed for each folder. The 'README.txt' file might include such things as explanations of naming conventions and how the structure of the directory relates to the structure of the project.

There are some excellent tools for organizing projects. Use appropriate tools, such as version control tools or electronic lab notebooks, to keep track of the history of the data files (more on this later in the semester).

3. Data Storage & Backup

3.1. What is backup?

1. What is the difference between a backup and an archive?

- Original Data
- Operation Data
- Backup
- Archive

2. Why backup?

- Hardware failure
- Software or media obsolescence
- Virus infection, malware, or malicious hacking
- Power failure
- Human error
- Future validation of results
- Data requests
- Legal Obligations: Lawsuits, FOIA reequests, agency mandates
- Required by funding agency or foundation
- Server, hardware, or software failure
- Financial instability of the projecct or organization

The Back-up Rule: 3-2-1

3-2-1: A secure backup requires a *minimum* of **3 copies** of your data on **2 types of storage media** with **one copy off-site**. Having 1 copy off-site protects your data from local risks like theft, lab fires, flooding, or natural disasters. Using 2 storage media improves the likelihood that at least one version will be readable in the future should one media type become obsolete or degrade unexpectedly. Having 3 copies helps ensure that your data will exist somewhere without being overly redundant. ***Be sure to migrate data from physical storage every 3-5 years***

Storage Media

Successful preservation depends in great part on storage media that are in good physical and operational condition. There are many different kinds of storage media that can be used to save and back-up digital files; each has pros and cons. They include:

- Desktop and Laptop Computers

3. Data Storage & Backup

- Campus servers
- Commercial Cloud Backup (e.g., Dropbox, Google Drive, Amazon, Carbonite, Spideroak). **Caution: if Google Drive or Dropbox are set up for file-syncing, then they are not a true backup.**
- External hard drives (range from disks to USB drives)
- Optical Storage (CD, DVD)
- Paper (e.g., printouts of spreadsheets and text files)

All storage media, whether hard drives, discs or data tapes, will wear out over time, rendering your data files inaccessible. To ensure ongoing access to both your active data files and your data archives, it is important to continually monitor the condition of your storage media and track its age. Older storage media and media that show signs of wear should be replaced immediately. **Use the following guidelines to ensure the ongoing integrity and accessibility of your data:**

1. **Test Your Storage Media Regularly:** It is important to routinely perform test retrievals or restorations of data you are storing for extended periods on hard drives, discs or tapes. It is recommended that storage media that is used infrequently be tested at least once a year to ensure the data is accessible.
2. **Beware of Early Hardware Failures:** A certain percentage of storage media will fail early due to manufacturing defects. In particular, hard drives, thumb drives and data tapes that have electronic or moving parts can be susceptible to early failure. When putting a new drive or tape into service, it is advisable to maintain a redundant copy of your data for 30 days until the new device “settles in.”
3. **Determine the Life of Your Hard Drives:** When purchasing a new drive unit, note the Mean Time Between Failure (MTBF) of the device, which should be listed on its specifications sheet (device specifications are usually packaged with the unit, or available online). The MTBF is expressed in the number of hours on average that a device can be used before it is expected to fail. Use the MTBF to calculate how long the device can be used before it needs to be replaced, and note that date on your calendar (For example, if the MTBF of a new hard drive is 2,500 hours and you anticipate having the unit powered on for 8 hours a day during the work week, the device should last about 2 years before it needs to be replaced).
4. **Routinely Inspect and Replace Data Discs:** Contemporary CD and DVD discs are generally robust storage media that will fail more often from mishandling and improper storage than from deterioration. However lower quality discs can suffer from delamination (separation of the disc layers) or oxidation. It is advisable to inspect discs every year to detect early signs of wear. Immediately copy the data off of discs that appear to be warping or discolored. Data tapes are susceptible both to physical wear and poor environmental storage conditions. In general, it is advisable to move data stored on discs and tapes to new media every 2-5 years (specific estimates on media longevity are available on the web).
5. **Handle and Store Your Media With Care:** All storage media types are susceptible to damage from dust and dirt exposure, temperature extremes, exposure to intense light, water penetration (more so for tapes and drives than discs), and physical shock. To help prolong its operational life, store your media in a dry environment with a

3. Data Storage & Backup

comfortable and stable room temperature. Encapsulate all media in plastic during transportation. Provide cases or plastic sheaths for discs, and avoid handling them excessively.

6. **Multimedia (e.g., photo, video, audio) backup and archiving is a bit more challenging, in part because transcriptions and captioning can be important for interpretation, discovery, and accessibility.** Storage of images solely on local hard drives or servers is not recommended. Unaltered images should be preserved at the highest resolution possible. Store original images in separate locations to limit the chance of overwriting and losing the original image. There are a number of options for metadata for multimedia data, including [MPEG standards](#), [PBCore](#), and the US Library of Congress standards for [still images](#), [sound](#), and [moving images](#).
7. **Finally, consider the short- and long-term security of the originals:** specimens, samples, documents and data sheets, photographs, or other physical items. Options include:
 - Campus Office (long-term security/stability: poor)
 - Lab (long-term security/stability: moderate)
 - Museum/Herbarium (long-term security/stability: high)
 - Departmental Office ((long-term security/stability: poor/moderate)
 - Commercial storage facility (long-term security/stability: depends on funding source)
 - Home ((long-term security/stability: poor)
 - Library (long-term security/stability: high)
 - Dryad, Zenodo, OSF, or other digital repository with long-term archiving via CLOCKSS or similar (long-term security/stability: high)

Backup Procedures

Backing up requires discipline and care to ensure nothing is missed and the file back-ups are secure. You can make this easier by doing the following:

Plan ahead, and write down your plan. A written data back-up and security plan includes such information as:

- where backups are located
- who can access backups and how they can be contacted
- how often data should be backed up
- what kind of backups are performed
- who is responsible for performing the backups and their contact information. For large projects or projects with high-volume data streams include a person with secondary responsibility (the back-up back-up) in case the primary person responsible is unavailable
- what hardware and software are used or recommended for performing backups
- how and how often to check if backups have been performed successfully
- the media are used to backup data
- a list of any data that are *not* archived or backed up

3. Data Storage & Backup

Backup your data at regular frequencies, with backup strategies (e.g., full, incremental, differential) optimized for the data collection process and data type. For instance, you should (at least):

- Back up when you complete your data collection activity
- Back up after you edit / clean data
- Streaming data (e.g., from data loggers) should be backed up at regularly scheduled points in the collection process
- High-value data should be backed up at much higher frequencies (daily)

Put procedures in place to make sure you follow your plan.

- set up calendar reminders
- use checklists.
- Ensure backup copies are identical to the originals (using checksums, file counts, etc.)
- Be sure of one of the regular calendar items is to verify successful recovery from a backup copy.
- ***Automate as much as possible.*** Automation simplifies frequent backups. but be careful with accidental file loss and that back-up copies are actually independent (e.g. Dropbox and a synced folder on your laptop are *not* independent copies).

Ensure the Security of Restricted Data.

- All data collected by UF affiliates falls into one of the classifications defined in the [UF Data Policy](#). Both original and electronic archives must be secured; failure to do so can have serious consequences for both researchers and institutions.

File formats for storage

For long term preservation is it necessary to store data in file formats that will be readable in the future and by a variety of operating systems. It is also important to provide descriptive information on these data file types and formats. This will facilitate data retrieval and reuse.

Store data and documentation using file-types that are open (ie., non-proprietary), uncompressed, unencrypted (if at all possible), and stable:

- ASCII formatted files will be readable into the future. For tabular data use comma-separated values, `.csv`, for text use `.txt` (alternatively `.rtf`).
- Images: TIFF (uncompressed)
- Video: MPEG-4 (`.mp4`) or motion JPEG 2000 (`.jp2`)
- AudioL Free Lossless Audio Codec (`.flac`)
- Documentation: `.txt` (preferred), PDF/A (`.pdf`)
- Structured, highly coded data: `.xml`
- For geospatial (raster) data the following provide a stable format:
 - GeoTIFF/TIFF
 - ASCII Grid
 - Binary image files
 - NetCDF
 - HDF or HDF-EOS

3. Data Storage & Backup

- For image (Vector) data use the following file formats (these are mostly proprietary data formats; please be sure to document the Software Package, Version, Vendor, and native platform):
 - ARCVIEW software: store components of an ArcView shape file (.shp, .sbx, .sbn, .prj, and .dbf files)
 - * ENVI – .evf (ENVI vector file)
 - * ESRI Arc/Info export file (.e00)
 - **Note:** Certain file formats, such as shapefiles, can be made up of as many as 7 individual files. If one of those files is absent from the file assembly the shapefile data utility may be lost. Awareness of adherence to a particular file format standard can also be helpful for determining, for example, if a particular software package can read the data file. Awareness of whether that standard or format is open source or proprietary will also influence how and if the data file can be read.

If a particular software package required to read and work with the data file, you need to make sure you have a copy, a backup copy, and a computer with the proper operating system to use the software.

For audio and image files, back up with the highest-quality file-type possible (i.e., the ‘lossless’ format rather than the ‘lossy’ format). For example, `jpeg` is lossy, meaning images saved with this file type will have less detail than images saved with the lossless `TIFF` format if at all possible back-up.

3.2. Tools & Resources

UF Library Guides

- UF Library: [Data File Types and Formats](#)
- UF Library: [Data Storage](#)
- UF IRB: [Data/Record Storage and Security](#)
- UF IT: [Data Classifications for Confidentiality & Security](#)

Overview of ‘Checksums’ and Checksum Calculators

- [Fisher, Tim. What Is a Checksum?](#) (updated 15 April 2020).

File Formats and Extensions

- UF library [recommended Data Formats for Preservation Purposes in the Florida Digital Archive](#)
- [What is XML?](#)
- [Common Windows File Extensions \(NMU IT\)](#)
- [Common File Extensions \(PC Net\)](#)
- [List of Open File Formats \(Wikipedia\)](#)
- [Common Windows File Extensions \(NMU IT\)](#)

3. Data Storage & Backup

- [Common File Extensions \(PC Net\)](#)
- [List of Open File Formats \(Wikipedia\)](#)
- [File formats-Best Practices \(Stanford Library\)](#)
- [Library of Congress](#)

UF-based Storage Options

- Overview of UF Cloud Data Services, aka [GatorCloud](#)
- [Free UF Dropbox for Education](#), [UF Dropbox FAQs](#), and information on how [your advisor can submit a request for your UF Dropbox account](#)
- [GStuite Allocation for UF personnel](#)
- [Free MS One Drive](#) (but also read why I suggest NOT using this [here](#))
- for very large data volumes or data data required extra security protection due to privacy restrictions, etc. seek the assistance of [UF Research Computing](#)

Storage and backup for very large volumes of data (multiple TB)

- [Cyverse](#)
- [Amazon Web Services \(AWS\) S3](#)
- [UF Research Computing](#)
- [Open Storage Network](#)
- [Argonne Leadership Computing Facility](#)
- [Globus](#)
- Uploading large files to Google drive: [tutorial blog post](#)

Tools for File Syncing

- [MacDropAny \(macOS\)](#)
- [MultCloud](#)
- Dropbox (use [via UF](#) for research, teaching)
- Google Drive (use [via UF](#) for research, teaching)

Portable HDs and Backup Services

- **Remember:** Dropbox and Google drive are not true backups if set up as a file syncing tool.
- NY Times *Wirecutter* Reviews & Recommendations:
- [portable hard drives](#)
- [automated data backup services](#); their recommendation was [SpiderOak](#).

Tools for Automating Data Uploading During Data Collection

- [IFTTT](#) and others

Online multimedia repositories and tools

- [YouTube](#)
- [Vimeo](#)
- [Flickr](#)
- [Google Photos](#)

These services have some advantages:

- are often low-cost or free
- are open to all
- have functions for provide community commenting and tagging
- some provide support for explicit licenses and re-use
- provide some options for valuable metadata such as geolocation
- may allow for large-scale dissemination
- optimize usability and low barrier for participation

However, they are commercial services, and hence have a number of potential drawbacks:

- models for sustainability is profit-based
- may have limits on file size or resolution
- may have unclear access, backup, and reliability policies, be sure to review them carefully

There are specialized photo repositories designed with researchers in mind.

- [Tropy](#)
- [MorphBank](#)

Some advantages of these are:

- often open-source, free, developed and maintained by academic institutions
- domain-specific metadata fields and controlled vocabularies customized for expert users
- highly discoverable for those in the same domain
- they can provide assistance in curating metadata
- they can optimize scientific use cases such as vouchering, image analysis
- may provide APIs for sharing or re-use for other projects
- they are recognized as high-quality, scientific repositories

But they too have some drawbacks

- rely on research or institutional/federal funding
- may require high-quality multimedia, completeness of metadata, or restrict manipulation
- may not be open to all
- may have restrictions on bandwidth usage

A step back: what needs to be preserved?

To meet multiple goals for preservation, researchers should think broadly about the digital products that their project generates, preserve as many as possible, preserve all that they are required to preserve for as long as required or longer, and plan the appropriate preservation

3. Data Storage & Backup

methods for each. Consider how long and how to preserve the following, taking into account (1) what would be necessary to reconstruct a complete data set if files downstream were lost (2), how long each needs to be kept, and (3) the cost of and space required for preserving data for different lengths of time:

1. Raw data (written form, electronic form). *Raw data are almost always worth preserving.*
2. Tables, spreadsheets, or databases of raw observation records and measurements
3. Tables, spreadsheets, or databases of clean observation records and measurements. *If clean data can be easily or automatically re-created from raw data, consider not preserving. If quality control or analysis is time-consuming or expensive, then consider preserving the clean version.*
4. Intermediate products: partly summarized or coded data that are the input to the next step in an analysis
5. Documentation of protocols used to clean, summarize, or code data
6. Software or algorithms developed to prepare data (cleaning scripts) or perform analyses. *Algorithms and software source code cost very little to preserve*
7. Results of an analysis, which can themselves be starting points or ingredients in future analyses, e.g. distribution maps, population trends, mean measurements. *These may be particularly valuable for future discovery and also cost very little to preserve.*
8. Any data sets obtained from others that were used in data processing

3.3. Reading and Sources

1. DataONE Community Engagement & Outreach Working Group, DataONE (July 01, 2010) “Best Practice: Plan for effective multimedia management”. Accessed through the Data Management Skillbuilding Hub at <https://dataoneorg.github.io/Education/bestpractices/plan-for-effective> on Aug 31, 2020
2. DataONE Best Practices Working Group, DataONE (July 01, 2010) “Best Practice: Ensure integrity and accessibility when making backups of data”. Accessed through the Data Management Skillbuilding Hub at <https://dataoneorg.github.io/Education/bestpractices/ensure-integrity-and> on Aug 31, 2020
3. Cindy Parr, Heather Henkel, DataONE (Aug 30, 2011) “Best Practice: Create and document a data backup policy”. Accessed through the Data Management Skillbuilding Hub at <https://dataoneorg.github.io/Education/bestpractices/create-and-document> on Aug 31, 2020
4. Cindy Parr, Heather Henkel, Keven Comerford, DataONE (May 11, 2011) “Best Practice: Decide what data to preserve”. Accessed through the Data Management Skillbuilding Hub at <https://dataoneorg.github.io/Education/bestpractices/decide-what-data> on Aug 31, 2020

4. Data Organization in Spreadsheets

4.1. Things to remember when organizing Data in Spreadsheets

Make your data tidy

- Spreadsheets should be a rectangle, with only rows and columns.
- Each column is a different variable (a thing you are measuring, like ‘weight’ or ‘temperature’).
- One row per observation. Each cell has only one value.
- Column headers: Use short meaningful column names with no spaces or special characters. Don’t start column names with numbers. Record units in column headers.
- Don’t enter the same data on multiple spreadsheets: Use one for each category of data to avoid duplicated data and to simplify corrections (e.g., taxonomy).
- Never put multiple tables in a single spreadsheet.
- Avoid spreading data across multiple sheets
- *Collecting* data in tidy format makes it easier to *enter* data in tidy format.

Use consistent names, abbreviations/codes, and capitalization.

- Write dates as YYYYMMDD. Better still have separate columns for Year, Month, and Day.
- Excel is unable to parse dates from before 1899-12-31. Be careful if your data include a mix of dates before and after this date, then you’ll have mixed data types in one column.¹
- Record zeros with a numeral (0), not a blank cells. For missing data use an appropriate null value indicator (e.g., NA).
- Don’t use formatting to convey information or to make your spreadsheet look pretty.
- *Remember that data format and excel defaults can vary by region.* For example, depending on the part of the world where a user is based, the default value for the decimal and thousands operator could be a , (comma) or a . (period); some regions use mm-dd for dates while others use dd-mm.

DO NOT EDIT OR CORRECT RAW DATA FILES!

- Once you are done with data entry, save your file in ‘read only’ format and make *all* corrections using scripting.
- Do *not* edit raw data after you have entered it in your spreadsheet!

¹The reason dates in Excel are so weird is that it is *accounting software*. It counts the days from a default of December 31, 1899, and thus stores July 2, 2014 as the serial number 41822. This is so one can easily calculate “days from a given date” for accounting purposes (like invoicing) by adding “date+XX days”.

4.2. Tools & Tutorials

1. [6 Reasons You Should Be Using Google Sheets Instead Of Excel](#)
2. Data Validation in Google Sheets: [blog post](#) and [video tutorial](#). A pdf version is available for download [here](#).
3. Why not bypass spreadsheets like Excel and use a csv editor like [Comma Chameleon][<https://comma-chameleon.io/>] instead? CC and other csv editors allow you to enter data in the same way - into cells, by adding and removing rows - and then export your file. But that's about it, which means you can't do many of the things (e.g., calculations, color in cells) that cause problems down the road.
4. More advanced users comfortable with R can also look into [Data Curator](#), with which you can create and edit tabular data from scratch or from a template, open Microsoft Excel and CSV files, and automatically correct common problems found in these and other file types.
5. Chris Prener, Trevor Burrows (Eds.). [Data Carpentry: Data Organization in Spreadsheets for Social Scientists](#).
6. Peter R. Hoyt, Christie Bahlai, Tracy K. Teal (Eds.), Erin Alison Becker, Aleksandra Pawlik, Peter Hoyt, Francois Michonneau, Christie Bahlai, Toby Reiter, et al. (2019, July 5). [datacarpentry/spreadsheet-ecology-lesson](https://datacarpentry.org/spreadsheet-ecology-lesson/): Data Carpentry: Data Organization in Spreadsheets for Ecologists, June 2019 (Version v2019.06.2). Zenodo. <http://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.3269869>

4.3. Reading and Sources

1. ***Essential reading:*** Broman, K. W., & Woo, K. H. (2018). Data organization in spreadsheets. *The American Statistician*, 72(1), 2-10. [\[read online\]](#)
2. DataONE Community Engagement & Outreach Working Group (2017) "Data Quality Control and Assurance". Accessed through the Data Management Skillbuilding Hub at https://dataoneorg.github.io/Education/lessons/05_qaqc/index on Aug 31, 2020
3. DataONE Community Engagement & Outreach Working Group (2017) "Data Entry and Manipulation". Accessed through the Data Management Skillbuilding Hub at https://dataoneorg.github.io/Education/lessons/04_entry/index on Aug 31, 2020

5. Reproducible Data Cleanup with R

5.1. Set up an RStudio Project and install the relevant packages

1. File -> New Project
2. Name the Project as follows: `las_demo`
3. Create the following three folders:

```
data_raw  
data_clean  
code
```

You can create these in the folder using your operating systems “create folder” option *or* you can create within R studio using the `files` tab

4. Install libraries, load libraries, and run verify they work by running a few commands

5.2. Gather the Raw Data to be corrected

Save your original (aka ‘raw’ or ‘dirty’) data files in the `data_raw` folder.

! Important

1. Never make changes to the original file of dirty/raw data. Never. **NEVER**. Always import the uncorrected original data file, make corrections using a script, and then save a new, clean file.
2. *Annotate your code with reminders for future you:* the `#` symbol (aka pound, hash tag) allows you to make comments in the script explaining what different sections or commands do. Annotate your scripts with lots of details on what different commands do, what is being done in each section, even links to websites you used to figure stuff out. Remember: ABA (*always be annotating*).

5.3. Take your data from messy to clean in these 6 steps:

1. Familiarize yourself with the data set
2. Check for potential errors. These can be structural errors (e.g., misaligned columns, duplicated rows/columns, missing values), data entry errors, or measurement errors. Decide how you will flag and deal with them.

5. Reproducible Data Cleanup with R

3. Decide how to deal with missing values
4. Identify ways to simplify data values (i.e., codes, abbreviations) and column headings
5. Write code to load the ‘raw’ data file, implement your corrections/changes, and save the ‘clean’ version of the data.

Things to look out for: Make a list of the what you think needs to be corrected and the steps necessary to identify and implement each correction. Some of the things to look out for include:

- Numeric values stored as character data types
- Factors stored as characters
- Duplicate rows
- Spelling mistakes
- inconsistent formatting (eg., codes, capitalizations)
- White spaces
- Missing data
- Zeros instead of null values
- Special characters (e.g. commas in numeric values instead of decimals)
- column headings with spaces between words or that start with numerals

Remember, *the characteristics of clean data set include:*

- Free of duplicate rows/values
- Error-free (correct misspellings, eliminate special characters)
- correct data type for analysis
- outliers identified and dealt in the correct way
- “tidy” data structure

💡 When working with multiple files, should you correct *before* or *after* combining?

We often need to combine multiple files with the same kind of data (i.e., surveys conducted in Year 1 and in Year 2, each of which are recorded in their own .csv file). Is it more efficient to correct each file first, then combine them, or combine first and *then* correct?

It depends and can vary from one project to another. Make an outline of the different steps and corrections to be made to each file and see if you can decide which is more efficient. Note that there might be different ways to do the same thing, this outline will help figure out which is best. For instance you could:

Option 1

1. Import table 1
2. Correct column headings in Table 1
3. Import table 2
4. Correct column headings in Table 2
5. Bind Table 1 and Table 2 Together

but this is less efficient than...

Option 2

1. Import table 1

2. Import table 2
3. Bind Table 1 and Table 2 Together
4. Correct the column headings in the Table

5.4. Tools & Resources

1. These introductions to R and R Studio were made by Professor Ethan White (UF-WEC). They are a good overview of some R basics.
 - [Intro to R and RStudio](#).
 - [Navigate R and RStudio web page](#)
 - [Intro to R Packages](#)
 - [Expressions and Variables in R](#)
2. The Carpentries' R workshops (self-paced or taught in-person) are excellent, I use many of their materials in class:
 - [R for Social Scientists](#)
 - [Data Analysis and Visualization in R for Ecologists](#)
3. Software Carpentry lesson on [Project Management with R Studio](#)
4. Hadley Wickham wrote a book on using the tidyverse and the [online version is FREE](#). This is a phenomenal resource on using R to import, tidy, and visualize data.
5. [RStudio Cheat Sheets](#): help with commands for using the different `tidyverse` packages, RStudio shortcuts and tricks, help with R commands, and more. You definitely want the ones for Data Import, Work with Strings, Factors, Data Transformation, and Base R.
6. Where and How to ask for help
 - Hadley Wickham's advice on [how to write a good reproducible example](#) for getting help with R
 - [how to post good questions on StackOverflow](#)
 - The UF [R-users listserv](#) is *very* user friendly and a great place to post requests for help.
7. [Ten simple rules for biologists learning to program](#)
8. Lot's more on the course's ['Resources' page](#)

5.5. Additional (interesting) Reading

1. Lewis, Keith P., Eric Vander Wal, and David A. Fifield. 2018. Wildlife biology, big data, and reproducible research. *Wildlife Society Bulletin* 42(1): 172-179.
2. White EP, Baldrige E, Brym ZT, Locey KJ, McGlinn DJ, Supp SR. 2013. Nine simple ways to make it easier to (re)use your data. *Ideas in Ecology and Evolution*. 6(2):1-10.

5. Reproducible Data Cleanup with R

3. [The humanities have a ‘reproducibility’ problem](#)
4. [The humanities do not need a replication drive](#)
5. [Reproducible Research: A primer for the social sciences](#)
6. [Replicability and replication in the humanities](#)
7. [Towards reproducible science in the digital humanities](#)
8. [The possibility and desirability of replication in the humanities](#)
9. [Reproducible Research: A Retrospective](#)

For when you feel more comfortable with R and programming

1. Bryan, J. (2018). Excuse me, do you have a moment to talk about version control? The American Statistician, 72(1), 20-27.
2. Wilson, Greg, Jennifer Bryan, Karen Cranston, Justin Kitzes, Lex Nederbragt, and Tracy K. Teal. Good enough practices in scientific computing. PLoS Computational Biology 13, no. 6 (2017): e1005510.

6. QA/QC: Reducing Error Entry, Finding and Correcting Errors

6.1. Reducing errors when entering data

Using 'Data Validation' Rules

1. Setting up Data Validation in Microsoft Excel: [[link to Microsoft post](#)] and a [tutorial video](#).
2. Setting up Data Validation in Google Sheets: [[link to post by Google](#)] and a [tutorial video](#)

Data entry with 'Text-to-Speech'

MS Excel (& other MS programs)

1. Converting text to speech in Excel for Microsoft 365, Excel 2010-2021 [[link](#)].
2. Microsoft for Mac: Hear selected text read aloud from Excel, Word, Power Point, and Outlook [[link](#)]. See also '*System Preferences->Accessibility*'
3. Video Tutorials
 - [Tutorial Video 1](#). This will allow you to select rows or columns of Excel and have them read back to you.
 - [Tutorial Video 2](#): it's not as thorough, but it is a bit easier to see the menu
 - [Tutorial Video 3](#). Because why not a third one?
1. If you are typing up written observations or field notes, the NY Times Wirecutter team thinks the [Dictation tool in MS Word](#) is the best way transcribe your written notes. It requires an internet connection to use, but [according to their review](#) "it handles medical terms and less-common words correctly more than most competing tools. It supports 34 languages, includes commands for punctuation, emoji, and other commonly used special characters, and allows you to format and navigate text with spoken commands."

Text-to-Speech in Google Docs

1. If you prefer working in Google Docs you can do the same thing. [This article](#) will show you how. You can also watch [this tutorial video](#).

Better still: ‘speak-on-enter’ to confirm data values as entered

1. Speak-on-enter [\[tutorial:\]](#)

Speech-to-Text for keyboardless data entry

1. Google Sheets: [Typing with your voice](#)
2. MS Word: [How to dictate documents](#)

Overview of Microsoft Accessibility Tools

1. ‘Narrator’ function [link](#)

6.2. R Packages for Data QA/QC

1. [janitor](#): simple functions for examining and cleaning dirty data. It was built with beginning and intermediate R users in mind and is optimized for user-friendliness. Advanced R users can already do everything covered here, but with janitor they can do it faster. (see this [mini-tutorial](#))
 - clean column names
 - remove empty rows and columns
 - remove duplicated rows
2. [cleanr](#). small R package for cleaning and checking data columns in a fast and easy way.
3. [unheadr](#): used to wrangle spreadsheets with embedded subheaders or values wrapped accross several rows (highlighting, merged cells, etc).

For more advanced R users:

1. Richard’s Iannone [pointblank](#) R package for Data Validation and Organization of Metadata [\[link\]](#)
2. [validate](#): designed to test data against a reusable set of data validation rules, investigate, summarize, and visualize data validation results, among other things
3. [Data Curator](#) is a simple desktop data editor to help describe, validate and share usable open data.
4. Kim, A. Y., Herrmann, V., Barreto, R., Calkins, B., Gonzalez-Akre, E., Johnson, D. J., Jordan, J. A., Magee, L., McGregor, I. R., Montero, N., Novak, K., Rogers, T., Shue, J., & Anderson-Teixeira, K. J. (2022). Implementing GitHub Actions continuous integration to reduce error rates in ecological data collection. *Methods in Ecology and Evolution*, 13, 2572–2585. <https://doi.org/10.1111/2041-210X.13982>

6.3. Readings & Sources

1. Campbell, J. L. *et al.* 2013. Quantity is nothing without quality: automated QA/QC for streaming environmental sensor data. *BioScience*, 63(7): 574-585. [link](#)
2. ***For more advanced users of R/Github:*** Kim, A. Y. *et al.* 2022. Implementing GitHub Actions continuous integration to reduce error rates in ecological data collection. *Methods in Ecology and Evolution*, 13, 2572– 2585. <https://doi.org/10.1111/2041-210X.13982>
3. Barchard, K. A., & Pace, L. A. (2011). Preventing human error: The impact of data entry methods on data accuracy and statistical results. *Computers in Human Behavior*, 27(5), 1834-1839. [link](#)
4. Atkinson, I. (2012). Accuracy of data transfer: double data entry and estimating levels of error. *Journal of Clinical Nursing*, 21(19pt20), 2730-2735.[link](#)
5. Goldberg, S. I., Niemierko, A., & Turchin, A. (2008). Analysis of data errors in clinical research databases. *AMIA Annual Symposium proceedings*. AMIA Symposium, 2008, 242–246. [link](#)
6. DataONE Education Module: Data Quality Control and Assurance. DataONE. Retrieved Nov12, 2012. From http://www.dataone.org/sites/all/documents/L05_DataQualityControlAssurance.pptx

7. Class Outline: QA/QC 2 - Open Refine



Figure 7.1.: How many ways can you spell....

7.1. OpenRefine

[Open Refine](#) is a powerful, free, and open source tool that is used to work with and clean messy data. The website includes a [user's manual](#) and links to [more tutorials](#).

7.2. OpenRefine Tutorials

- Data Carpentry: [Data Cleaning with OpenRefine for Social Scientists](#).
- Data Carpentry: [Data Cleaning with OpenRefine for Ecologists](#)
- Environmental Data Initiative [OpenRefine Tutorial](#)
- Cleaning Data with OpenRefine Video Tutorials:
 - [Video Tutorial No. 1](#)
 - [Video Tutorial No. 2](#)
- JHU Library: [Cleaning Data with OpenRefine](#)
- The Programming Historian: [Cleaning Data with OpenRefine](#).

7.3. GREL Cheatsheets

- Belinda Weaver's [GREL Cheatsheet with examples](#)
- [OpenRefine GREL Manual](#)
- A really good [GREL Guide](#) from the Univ Illinois
- Even better: code4lib Toronto's [OpenRefine cheatsheets](#), including for GREL commands.
- Datenschule's [OR Cheatsheets](#)

7.4. R Tools for OpenRefine

- The [rrefine package](#) allows you to do some OpenRefine tasks from within R.

8. Metadata

Data repositories such as [Dryad](#) and [ICPSR](#) are designed to permanently store the data that are used in research so it is available to future scholars. To use the data, it is important to have good *metadata*: metadata describe the data themselves, rather than why the study was conducted, hypotheses, results, or conclusions. Metadata include thorough description of the data file, the context in which the data were collected, the measurements that were made, the tools used to gather the data, and the quality of the data themselves.

We want data and metadata to adhere to the FAIR Principles for [Scientific Data Management and Stewardship](#), meaning they should be:

- Findable: persistent identifiers & basic machine-actionable metadata
- Accessible: can be read by machines & humans
- Interoperable: use shared vocabularies / ontologies, machine-accessible (meta)data
- Re-Usable: descriptions allow others to reuse and link with other data sources

The metadata for the types of data used in our work should also (typically) include the 5 Classes of metadata descriptors from [Michener *et al.* 1997](#)

- Class I: alert potential secondary users to the existence of data sets that fall within specific temporal, spatial, and thematic domains.
- Class II: describe the research resulting in a data set.
- Class III: status of the data set and information on its accessibility.
- Class IV: all the attributes related to the structure of the data file.
- Class V: all other related information that might be necessary for secondary usage, publishing the data set, or auditing the data set.

8.1. What are Metdatadata?

1. E. Bruna Video for LAS6292: [Why Metadata?](#)
2. ICPSR: [What is a Codebook?](#)

8.2. Best practices for preparing metadata

1. “[Best Practices in Creating Social Science Metadata.](#)” p.32 in the ICPSR *Guide to Social Science Data Preparation and Archiving: Best Practice Throughout the Data Life Cycle (6th Edition)*.
2. Michener, W.K., et al . 1997. Non-geospatial metadata for the ecological sciences. *Ecological Applications* 7: 330–342.
[\[read online\]](#)

3. Pp 446-450 in Bernard, H.R. and Bernard, H.R., 2013. Social research methods: Qualitative and quantitative approaches. Sage.
4. ICPSR [Guide to Social Science Data Preparation and Archiving: Best Practice Throughout the Data Life Cycle \(6th Edition\)](#)
5. DataONE Community Engagement & Outreach Working Group (2017) “[Metadata Management](#)”. Accessed through the Data Management Skillbuilding Hub on Aug 31, 2020

8.3. Discipline-specific metadata standards

It is worth looking in these catalogs to see if you can find metadata standards for your discipline. They will provide suggestions on not only what to include, but the standard vocabulary for your discipline.

1. RDA [Catalog of metadata standards for different disciplines](#)
2. UK Digital Curation Center [Directory of metadata standards for different disciplines](#)
3. Ecological data: [Ecological Metadata Language](#)
4. Museum Specimens: [Darwin Core](#)
5. Geography Markup Language ([GML](#)): Emphasis on geographic features (roads, highways, bridges)
6. Humanities: UF Digital Collections (UFDC) [key metadata fields](#) used for non-published items such as posters, archival materials, artists’ files, field notebooks, etc. Includes a link to a template you can download. See also the different [Metadata Preparation Guides](#) provided by the University of Florida Digital Collections (UFDC), the [UF Humanities Archives Metadata Template](#), and the [metadata required by the Qualitative Data Repository](#).
- 7, Linguistics: [Lameta](#) is a tool to help with organising collections of files, aimed primarily at collections made in the course of documenting language, music, and other cultural expressions.

8.4. Metadata templates

I have created metadata templates based on information from ICSPR (for social sciences) and Michener *et al.* 1997 (for biophysical sciences) that can be downloaded and edited; you can add more fields or delete any that are not relevant. Note that Table 1 in Michener *et al.* is much more comprehensive and provides additional guidance on how to make sure the metadata are useful. The templates are available in `.txt`, `.Rmd`, and `.qmd` format).

1. **Metadata Template for Social Sciences** based on ICSPR standards: [.txt format](#) or [.Rmd format](#).

8. Metadata

2. **Metadata template for Biophysical Sciences** based on Table 1 from Michener *et al.* 1997: [.txt format](#) or [.Rmd format](#)
3. **Metadata for the Humanities or those working primarily with Qualitative Data:** The metadata required often depend on the type of material with which you work (e.g., oral history, photos, digital, printed). If your data is in this domain, you can use this general template from the UF Humanities Archives: [Template #2](#). You can also review the [metadata required by the Qualitative Data Repository](#).

8.5. Tools for creating machine-readable metadata

I include these here in case you want to try using them. It's not required, but it could definitely make your life easier if there is a standard tool for your discipline (e.g., MORPHO if you are working with ecological data).

1. [giant list from the RDA](#) of tools for creating standardized metadata for different disciplines
2. [USGS Metadata Wizard](#)
3. [TKME](#)
4. [CatMDEdit](#)
5. [Coastal and Marine Science Data Repository - GRIIDC](#): Select the [Dataset Information Form Guidance](#) from the [Training and User Guides](#) page.

8.6. Metadata Dictionaries

1. [USGS](#)
2. [Global Change Master Dictionary](#) [Note: deprecated June 2020]
3. [USGS Geographic Names](#)
4. [Getty Thesaurus of Geographic Names](#)

8.7. Organizations developing metadata standards and schema

1. [The Research Data Alliance \(RDA\)](#) “has the goal of building the social and technical infrastructure to enable open sharing and re-use of data.”
2. [DDI Alliance](#): “Established in 2003, the Data Documentation Initiative Alliance (DDI Alliance) is an international collaboration dedicated to establishing metadata standards and semantic products for describing social science data, data covering human activity, and other data based on observational methods.”
3. [The Dublin Core Metadata Initiative](#) is “an organization supporting innovation in metadata design and best practices across the metadata ecology”.

9. Data Management Plans

9.1. Reminder: What is a DMP?

- Formal document that lays out your plan for managing the data you will collect (or have collected).
- Outlines what you will do with your data during and after you complete your research
- Ensures your data is safe for the present and the future
- [Video overview](#) by RWTH Aachen University (12 min).

9.2. Why do one?

- Save time
- Less reorganization later
- Increase research efficiency
- Makes it easier to archive data down the road (some data centers and repositories have specific requirements for data documentation, and knowing these requirements in advance saves time and effort that might be spent trying to correct data after they are collected).
- Increasingly: you don't have a choice. Many funding agencies (e.g., NSF, NIH, NEH) now require a DMP for proposal submission.

9.3. What are the components of a DMP?

1. Information about data & data format
2. Metadata content and format
3. Policies for access, sharing and re-use
4. Long-term storage and data management
5. Roles and responsibilities
6. Budget

For details on what information should be included in each component, see “DMP Details” below.

Example: DMP for NSF Proposals

“Plans for data management and sharing of the products of research. Proposals must include a supplementary document of no more than two pages labeled “Data Management Plan”. This supplement should describe how the proposal will conform to NSF policy on the dissemination and sharing of research results, and may include:

the types of data, samples, physical collections, software, curriculum materials, and other materials to be produced in the course of the project the standards to be used for data and metadata format and content (where existing standards are absent or deemed inadequate, this should be documented along with any proposed solutions or remedies) policies for access and sharing including provisions for appropriate protection of privacy, confidentiality, security, intellectual property, or other rights or requirements policies and provisions for re-use, re-distribution, and the production of derivatives plans for archiving data, samples, and other research products, and for preservation of access to them.”

Some funders or institutions may require specific elements in a data management plan; you should check in advance to make sure you meet all requirements

9.4. Start Here

1. The [DMP Tool \(https://dmptool.org/\)](https://dmptool.org/) is a free, open-source, application that helps researchers create data management plans (DMPs). It provides an easy-to-use platform for creating a DMP that complies with the requirements of different private and public funding agencies (e.g., foundations, NSF, NIH). It also has direct links to funder websites, help text for answering questions, and data management best practices resources.

9.5. What should go in my DMP?

1. Qualitative Data have some unique issues regarding their description and storage, so the [Qualitative Data Archive](#) has put together a great checklist of things to consider.
2. [Short Checklist & Questions to Consider](#) when putting together a DMP
3. [Very in-depth Checklist & Questions to Consider](#) when putting together a DMP
4. [UF Library Guidelines](#) for preparing a DMP

9.6. Sample DMPs

NSF DMPs

1. NSF General: [Mauna Loa example](#)
2. NSF General: [Rio Grande example](#)
3. NSF DEB: [Emilio Bruna Heliconia example](#)

Sample DMPs on the ‘DMP Tool’ website

1. [Public DMPs](#) (*note: “Public DMPs are plans created using the dmptool service and shared publicly by their owners. They are not vetted for quality, completeness, or adherence to funder guidelines.”*)

Humanities DMPs

1. National Endowment for the Humanities: Data Management Plans From Successful Grant Applications (2015-2018) and (2011 - 2014) can be found as downloadable zip files [on this page](#)
2. A *really* nice [DMP for a Digital Humanities Project](#) by researchers at the University of Maryland, College Park.

9.7. DMP Details

1. Information About Data & Data Format

1.1 Description of data to be produced

- Experimental
- Observational
- Raw or derived
- Physical collections
- Models and their outputs
- Simulation outputs
- Curriculum materials
- Software
- Images
- Other

1.2 How data will be acquired?

- When? Where? Method?

1.3 How data will be processed

- Software used
- Algorithms
- Workflows
- Data transformations/formats needed (Consider archive policies)
- *This step is important to consider before the project since it may affect how data are organized, what formats are used, and how much should be budgeted for hardware and software. Things to consider are what software may be used, what algorithms will be employed, how these fit into the overall workflow of the project.*

1.4 File formats

- Justification
- Naming conventions

1.5 Quality assurance & control during sample collection, analysis, and processing

1.6 Existing data

9. Data Management Plans

- If existing data are used, what are their origins?
- Will your data be combined with existing data?
- What is the relationship between your data and existing data?

1.7 How data will be managed in short-term

- Version control
- Backing up
- Security & protection
- Who will be responsible

2. Metadata Content & Format

- Metadata defined:
- Documentation and reporting of data
- Contextual details: Critical information about the dataset
- Information important for using the data
- Descriptions of temporal and spatial details, instruments, parameters, units, files, etc.

2.1 What metadata are needed

- Details that make data meaningful

2.2 How metadata will be created and/or captured

- Lab notebooks? GPS units? Auto-saved on instrument?

2.3 What format will be used for the metadata

- Standards for community
- Justification for format chosen

3. Policies for Access, Sharing, Reuse

3.1 Obligations for sharing

- Funding agency
- Institution
- Other organization
- Legal

3.2 Details of data sharing

- How long?
- When?
- How access can be gained?
- Data collector rights

3.2 Ethical/privacy issues with data sharing

3.3 Intellectual property & copyright issues

- Who owns the copyright? (? Institutions and/or funding agencies often have a policy for intellectual property and copyright. There may be other considerations such as embargos on data due to patents, politics, or journal requirements.)

9. Data Management Plans

- Institutional policies
- Funding agency policies
- Embargos for political/commercial reasons

3.4 *Intended future uses/users for data*

- This helps determine the most appropriate data center to archive your data.

3.5 *Citation*

- How should data be cited when used?
- Do you need a persistent citation (e.g. DOI)?

4. Long-term Storage & Data Management

4.1 *What data will be preserved* 4.2 *Where will it be archived*

- Most appropriate archive for data
- Community standards

4.4 *Who will be responsible*

- Contact person for archive

5. Roles and responsibilities

5.1 *Outline the roles and responsibilities for implementing this data management plan.*

- Who will be responsible for data management and for monitoring the data management plan? How will adherence to this data management plan be checked or demonstrated? What process is in place for transferring responsibility for the data? Who will have responsibility over time for decisions about the data once the original personnel are no longer available?

6. Budget

6.1 *Anticipated costs*

- Time for data preparation & documentation
- Hardware/software for data preparation & documentation
- Personnel
- Archive costs

6.2 *How costs will be paid*

- Server Access, Hard Drives or other media
- Printing costs
- Personnel to manage data, backups, and data use requests

9.8. REMINDER

The key components of a DMP are:

- Information about data & data format
- Metadata content and format
- Policies for access, sharing and re-use
- Long-term storage and data management
- Budget

9.9. Resources

10. Some sample DMPs

1. DataOneDMP samples for NSF
 - NSF General: [Mauna Loa example](#)
 - NSF General: [Rio Grande example](#)
 - NSF General: [HDF Map example](#)
 - NSF General: [Nutrient Network example](#)
 - NSF BIO: [E. affinis example](#)
2. Sample DMPs on the ‘DMP Tool’ website [Public DMPs](#)(note: “**Public DMPs are plans created using the dmptool service and shared publicly by their owners. They are not vetted for quality, completeness, or adherence to funder guidelines.**”)
3. National Endowment for the Humanities: Data Management Plans From Successful Grant Applications (2015-2018) and (2011 - 2014) can be found as downloadable zip files [on this page](#)
4. A *really* nice [DMP for a Digital Humanities Project](#) by researchers at the University of Maryland, College Park.

11. Additional resources to help prepare your DMP

1. Qualitative Data have some unique issues regarding their description and storage, so the [Qualitative Data Archive](#) has put together a great checklist of things to consider.
2. [Short Checklist & Questions to Consider](#) when putting together a DMP
3. [Very in-depth Checklist & Questions to Consider](#) when putting together a DMP
4. [UF Library Guidelines](#) for preparing a DMP
5. Another tools for creating DMPs is the [DMP Online](#)

12. Efficient Data Collection

12.1. Introduction

The goal of efficient data collection is **Error Reduction**:

- At the time of data collection
- When transferring to electronic format

We can reduce the introduction of errors using **Process Audits** - a tool borrowed from industrial engineering that helps to identify *where* errors are likely to sneak in.

12.2. Forms

Many data collection errors are the result of poorly designed tools for recording information. **Most people, whether they know it or not, collect data on some kind of form.** Sometimes these forms are paper, sometimes electronic. Notes scribbled on a piece of paper or MS Word document? Both are simple ‘forms’. To design better forms - forms that reduce the number of errors at both the collection and entry phases - we will use some ideas from manufacturing, shipping, and design industries, along with loads of research on forms themselves.

- **Lists:** We forget things we need, and we forget things we need to do. Lists prevent that.
- **Automation:** When collected repeated measurements on a single thing, or the same measurement on many things, attempt to invest in automation.
- **Asset Management:** There is no need to have people (data collectors or study subjects) write down information you know in advance. Use things like labels & Bar/QR codes to simplify things as much as possible.
- **UX/UI:** The arrangement of things on a page, and the cues used to guide input, can help reduce errors and increase form completion rates. We know this thanks to websites that depend on you filling out information to get your business; they have done lots of testing to come up with forms that ensure you don’t leave the site without giving them the information they need. And so with that in mind....

12.2.1. Lessons from UI/UX

Whenever possible, the instrument for recording information (e.g., form, online survey) should strive to:

1. Reduce Cognitive Overload. Keep the form simple, easy to read, and easy to follow.

2. Require writing as little as possible
 - Use labels & keep them short...
 - ...and pay attention to where you put the labels
 - Use the appropriate input type and tag...
 - ...and format them in helpful ways
 - Forms should be one column...
 - ...Except when multi-column makes sense
 - Group related fields
 - AVOID ALL CAPS
 - For online forms: Show all options if < 6 (unless space is limited)
 - Number questions and responses
 - Use Formatting to guide the data collectors
 - Avoid 2x-sided forms
 - Give each sheet a unique ID number
 - Add collector info

12.3. Checklists

Another reason errors get introduced is because we fail/forget to collect the required data (an error of omission) or because the equipment used to collect the data fails or is unavailable (e.g., the recorder runs out of batteries, the recorder is left behind, the recorder is dropped in the river). *Checklists* are an essential way of minimizing the likelihood of these data collection errors.

Checklists are easy to make and share; here are some examples of checklists made by previous courses. The RMarkdown files used to make them can be seen and edited in [this Github folder](#). There are also blank templates in [RMarkdown](#) and [Quarto](#) format to make your own.

12.3.1. Example Checklists made in Prior Classes

- First Aid Kit [pdf](#), [Rmd](#)
- Supplies & equipment for international travel & fieldwork [pdf](#), [Rmd](#)
- Vehicle & vessel maintenance review: [pdf](#), [Rmd](#) [Rmd](#)
- Surveying Farmers Project Checklist [pdf](#), [Rmd](#)
- Materials for rural focus groups [pdf](#), [Rmd](#)

12.4. Tools, & Resources

12.4.1. Forms

1. Schiavo, F. [The bad design of everyday things #3 — Paper Forms](#).
2. Maloney, S. [Best Practices for PaperBased Form Design](#)
3. [How to design survey forms for quick data entry](#). This is a great post with suggestions on designing survey forms for work in an international / multi-language context.

4. Best Practice for Form Design: [one](#) and [two](#). These suggestions come from a UX-perspective for online forms, so they might seem most appropriate for online surveys. But the suggestions are really good for paper survey forms as well.
5. [make a template for data entry \(form\) with Excel](#)
6. ‘[Google Forms Essential Training](#)’ (requires UF login)
7. [Interesting examples of poor UX practices](#)
8. ‘[Form Design: 13 Empirically Backed Best Practices](#)’
9. ‘[Best Practices For Mobile Form Design](#)’
10. Software: [TapForms](#)
11. Software: [Jotform](#)

12.4.2. Checklists

1. Atul Gawande’s [The Checklist Manifesto](#)
2. Paula Rizzo’s LinkedIn Course [The Power of Lists](#)
3. Clear for [iOS](#) and for [Android](#)
4. [ToDoist](#) especially powerful; lists can be shared with team members and sync across devices
5. [Evernote](#) really more of a note-taking app, but good for lists too
6. NYTimes Wirecutter Review of [Best To-Do List Apps](#)

12.4.3. Creating and Printing Labels

1. [Avery Waterproof labels](#)

12.4.4. QR Codes

1. Make QR Codes in Word, Powerpoint, or Excel [Tutorial #1](#), [Tutorial #2](#)
2. Make [QR Codes with R](#)
3. Leila Gharani: [Create QR Codes for FREE | Use Anywhere (Excel, Word & Power-Point)]
4. [How to Create a QR Code and Use It Effectively](#)
5. [Mass Generate QR Codes to Prefill Google Forms](#)
6. ‘[Top 10 Barcode Scanner AppsFor iPhone and Android](#)’

12.5. Assigned Readings & Videos

1. Redman, T. 2016. Bad Data Costs the U.S. \$3 Trillion Per Year. Harvard Business Review. [\[download pdf\]](#)
2. Atul Gawande’s TED Talk: [The Importance & Value of the CHECK LIST](#). Follow-up with the details in this good [animated summary](#).
3. Jess Stratton (LinkedIn Learning) Video Overview: [Use Google Forms to Create Surveys](#) (7 min.)

12. Efficient Data Collection

4. OPTIONAL: A more advanced, multi-video [Google Forms Essential Training Course](#) has short (1-3 min) videos explaining each step in more detail. It's great, and only 39 min long from start to finish.

13. Transcription & Translation

! Warning

Prior to using commercial transcription or translation services you should have them approved by [UF's Integrated Risk Management Team](#), especially if you are working with 'Sensitive' or 'Restricted' data. Even if working with public data, you may wish to verify how the company is storing and using your files (i.e., if they are using them to train their models).

13.1. Transcription

Transcription tools & software

The [UF International Ethnography Lab](#) has access to [Trint Transcription Software](#), which has [detailed tutorials](#)

Reviews of transcription tools

1. [Comparison Video](#)
2. NY Times' Wirecutter [review of paid transcription services](#). Their recommendations include both human- and AI-transcription of video and audio with per-minute pricing.

Tools: Automated Transcription of spoken speech

1. Speech-to-text [with Google Docs](#)
2. Speech-to-text with [MS Word](<https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/office/transcribe-your-recordings-7fc2efec-245e-45f0-b053-2a97531ecf57>): Word Desktop or Online: Go to Home > Dictate Box > Transcribe. The Settings wheel allows you to choose the microphone and language.

Tools: Automated Transcription via file upload

Top-Tier

1. [Otter.ai](#). English only (US & UK with regional accents); free (600 min/mo) and paid plans. Can transcribe zoom meetings (e.g., if you do interviews via zoom) and can [integrate with Dropbox](#). Phone app is available for [iOS](#). There is an [online tutorial](#). *English-only*
2. [Happy Scribe](#) - see description above.
3. [Temi](#). *English Only*, less accurate than Otter.ai and Happy Scribe.
4. [Zoom via UF](#); see also this [Link](#) and this announcement about the addition of [new languages for UF users](#)
5. [IBM Watson](#), go to the [Demo Site](#). note the “detect multiple speakers” option.
6. MS Word (for Commercial Clients): Instructions [here](#).
 - Transcription from audio file (Word Online): Go to Home > Dictate Dropdown Arrow > Transcribe. A side panel will open, follow the prompts to upload the audio file and choose options.

Second-Tier

1. [Spext](#). Speech-audio-text editing; free and paid plans.
2. [Amazon Transcribe](#)

Tools: Automated transcription via API

1. [googleLanguageR](#). Uses the Google Cloud machine learning APIs for text and speech tasks. The [Cloud Speech API](#) transcribes sound files to text and the Cloud Text-to-Speech AP
2. [AWS transcribe](#) uses the Amazon Web Services to do transcription via API. Has program for NGO/non-profits.

Tools: Automated transcription via dictation

1. [Google Docs](#). See also [Google Docs Voice Recognition](#) and [helpful how-to blog post on transcription using google docs and voice recognition](#)
2. [Express Scribe](#) and [a tutorial](#). There is a free version. *Approved by UF for Open and Sensitive Data; approval required for Restricted Data.*
3. [SpeechNotes](#)
4. [Apple Dictation](#) and [Dictation Commands](#)
5. [How to use Windoes Voice Dictation](#) and [Windows Speech Recognition Commands](#)

Tools: “Manual” transcription

1. [oTranscribe](#) Incredibly easy, web based, with time stamps, variable speed.
2. [Transcribe](#)
3. [Nvivo](#)
4. [Listen N Write](#)
5. [InScribe](#)
6. [Pearnote for Mac](#): make text annotations that connect to locations in audio and video recordings (30 day free trial)
7. [Dragon Speech Recognition Software](#)
8. [Sonix](#)
9. Adobe Premiere: [Speech-to-Text Tutorial](#) and [Workaround if you are using a version later than 7.2.2](#). UF Students can use Adobe products on [UFApps](#)

Transcription Style & Coding Guides

1. Samuel Proctor Project [Style Guide](#)
2. Library of Congress Guide: [How to Transcribe](#)
3. Smithsonian Archives of American Art [Style Guide](#)
4. Smithsonian Volunteer Transcription Program’s [Guide](#) and [Expert Tips](#)
5. Guide to [Transcription Coding](#)
6. Hepburn, A., & Bolden, G. B. (2017). Transcribing for social research. Sage. [link to book description on Sage website](#)
7. Manchester University’s very useful [Transcription Toolkit and Guide](#)
8. Manchester University’s [Quick calculator for estimating transcribing time \(.xls file\)](#)
9. Programming Historian Guide to [Text Automation](#)

Examples of Transcription Notes

1. [Sample 1](#)
2. [Sample 2](#)

13.1.1. Setting up Text Shortcuts

1. [Google Docs](#)
2. [MS Word](#)

Useful Websites and Tutorials

Dictionaries, Slang, and Colloquialisms

1. [Linguee](#) Good for slang and expressions; searches different ways in which one word has been translated. Can also enter several words or even a sentence to find different translations.
2. [Thesaurus.com](#); equivalent in foreign language.

Text comparison

1. Side-by-Side [Text Comparison Website](#)

Tutorials and Reviews

1. Jennifer Marie's YouTube channel on [Transcription Tools & Tips](#)

Equipment

Pedals

1. [Infinity](#)
2. [Kinesis](#)

Misc. Software & Apps

1. [SayMore](#): tools for common Language Documentation tasks
2. [Lameta](#) tool for metadata associated with files made in the course of documenting language, music, and other cultural expressions.
3. [voice recorder app](#) for iPad
4. [App for recording phone interviews](#) (note: be aware of relevant local and national laws regarding recording phone calls).

Post-Transcription Text Analytics

1. [Planning for text analytics \(extraction and organization\) in R](#)
2. Silge and Robinson's **outstanding** book '[Text Analysis in R](#)'

13.2. Translation

Tools: Automated Translation of Text

1. [Google Translate](#) and [help documents](#).
2. Google Docs: [in-doc translation](#). See also how to [translate using google sheets](#)
3. MS Word: [in-doc translation](#)
4. [DeepL](#)

Tools: Automated Translation of Audio

1. [Happy Scribe](#). 40+ languages. 30 min. free then paid; [student pricing available](#). Can integrate with Zapier to up/download files from [Google Drive](#) and [Dropbox](#) *Multiple languages*
 2. Google Audio Translation [in Beta](#) ### Text or Audio: API or Command Line
 3. [googleLanguageR](#). Uses the Google Cloud machine learning APIs for text and speech tasks. The [Cloud Translation API](#) does detection and translation of text.
 4. [aws.translate](#) uses the Amazon Web Services to do transcription via API. Has program for NGO/non-profits.
1. [Watson \(IBM\)](#) 500 minutes free
 2. [DeepL](#)
 3. [Translate Shell](#) via API

13.2.1. Tools: Manual Translation of Text with Computer Assisted Technology (CAT)

1. Video overview of different [CAT Tools](#) from ‘Freelanceverse’.
2. [OmegaT CAT Software](#). (Free)
3. [WordFast Anywhere](#) (free online; desktop version are paid)
4. [Across.net](#) (basic version free)

13.3. Sources & Additional Readings

1. Young, JC, Rose, DC, Mumby, HS, et al. 2018. A methodological guide to using and reporting on interviews in conservation science research. *Methods Ecol Evol* 9:10-19 [\[link\]](#)
2. Michael Henry Heim & Andrzej W. Tymowski. [Guidelines for the Translation of Social Science Texts](#). *American Council of Learned Societies*
3. Sophie Chabeda, Jane Kahindi, Manya Van Ryneveld. [Preparing data: the not-so-simple stage of transcription and translation](#)
4. Squires, A. 2009. [Methodological challenges in cross-language qualitative research: A research review..](#) *International Journal of Nursing Studies* 46(2):277-287.
5. Hepburn, A., & Bolden, G. B. (2017). [Transcribing for social research](#). Sage.
6. McLellan E, MacQueen KM, Neidig JL. 2003. Beyond the Qualitative Interview: Data Preparation and Transcription. *Field Methods*. 15(1):63-84. [\[link\]](#)
7. MacLean LM, Meyer M, Estable A. 2004. Improving Accuracy of Transcripts in Qualitative Research. *Qualitative Health Research*.14(1):113-123. [\[link\]](#)
8. Hughes, M. [Are Online Transcription Services Safe and Private?](#). *How-to-Geek*.
9. Duca, Daniela. [Who's disrupting transcription in academia?](#). *Sage Ocean*.
10. Oliver, D. G., Serovich, J. M., & Mason, T. L. (2005). Constraints and opportunities with interview transcription: Towards reflection in qualitative research. *Social forces*, 84(2), 1273-1289. [\[link\]](#)
11. Moore, E., & Llompарт, J. (2017). Collecting, Transcribing, Analyzing and Presenting Plurilingual Interactional Data. *Research-publishing.net*. [\[link\]](#)

14. Paperless Data Collection

14.1. Recommended Platform: EpiCollect

1. EpiCollect [Homepage](#)
2. Download the app for [Apple iOS](#) and [Android Phones])
3. [User's guide](#)
4. [Intro to EpiCollect 5](#)
5. [Creating an EpiCollect PROJECT](#)
6. [Creating a FORM for your Epicollect Project](#)
7. [Collecting data in EpiCollect with your phone or tablet](#)
8. Aanensen DM, Huntley DM, Feil EJ, al-Own F, Spratt BG (2009) EpiCollect: Linking Smartphones to Web Applications for Epidemiology, Ecology and Community Data Collection. PLoS ONE 4(9): e6968. [link](#)

14.2. Paid platforms for paperless data collection

1. [Fulcrum](#); [link to post](#) describing how it was used by an NGO.
2. [ODK](#)

14.3. Useful smartphone apps for fieldwork

1. Lists of useful apps for data collection in the field: Start with the [Bruna Lab Super-List](#) (*if you want to suggest any additions to the list please do so [here](#)*). You can also check [\[list 2\]](#), [\[list 3\]](#), [\[list 4\]](#), [\[list 5\]](#), and [\[list 6\]](#)
2. BES: [Research at Home - Using a Smartphone for Data Collection](#)
3. EOS: [Streamlining Field Data Collection with Mobile Apps](#)

14.4. Google Sheets

1. [Using IFTTT with Google Sheets](#) (LinkedIn Learning Course, requires UF login).

14.5. Mobile Form Design

1. [Best Practices for the design of mobile forms](#)
2. [Optimal design of text fields in sheets](#)

14.6. Barcode Scanner Apps

1. [Top 10 barcode scanner apps for iPhone and Android](#)
2. [Comparison of top free barcode and QR code scanner apps](#)

14.7. Photos as Paperless Data Collection

1. Organizing Photos and annotating photos with [Tropy](#). Open source; Allows export of notes and metadata to CSV, JSON, etc.

14.8. DIY

1. Sometimes to go paperless you can hack the tools you use: [Send measurements from digital calipers to Excel Sheet](#)

14.9. Additional Reading

1. [Keep calm and go paperless: Electronic lab notebooks can improve your research](#)
2. [NOAA Pathways to paperless Data Collection](#)
3. Thieler ER, Zeigler SL, Winslow LA, Hines MK, Read JS, Walker JI (2016) Smartphone-Based Distributed Data Collection Enables Rapid Assessment of Shorebird Habitat Suitability. PLoS ONE 11(11): e0164979. [link](#)
4. Teacher, A. G., Griffiths, D. J., Hodgson, D. J., & Inger, R. (2013). Smartphones in ecology and evolution: a guide for the app-rehensive. Ecology and evolution, 3(16), 5268–5278. [link](#)
5. Palumbo, M.J., Johnson, S.A., Mundim, F.M., Lau, A., Wolf, A.C., Arunachalam, S., Gonzalez, O., Ulrich, J.L., Washuta, A. and Bruna, E.M. (2012), Harnessing Smartphones for Ecological Education, Research, and Outreach. The Bulletin of the Ecological Society of America, 93: 390-393. [link](#)
6. Rayhan, R. U., Zheng, Y., Uddin, E., Timbol, C., Adewuyi, O., & Baraniuk, J. N. (2013). Administer and collect medical questionnaires with Google documents: a simple, safe, and free system. Applied Medical Informatics, 33(3), 12-21. [link](#)
7. Moylan, C. A., Derr, A. S., & Lindhorst, T. (2013). Increasingly mobile: How new technologies can enhance qualitative research. Qualitative social work: research and practice, 14(1), 36-47. [link](#)

14. Paperless Data Collection

8. Harari, G. M., Lane, N. D., Wang, R., Crosier, B. S., Campbell, A. T., & Gosling, S. D. (2016). Using Smartphones to Collect Behavioral Data in Psychological Science: Opportunities, Practical Considerations, and Challenges. *Perspectives on Psychological Science* 11(6), 838-854.

15. Automated Data Collection & Extraction

Automating your data collection is one of the best ways to make your research more efficient and free up time to do other things. Some of these techniques take time to learn, but so take into account the time required to learn a method and the return on investment for the effort.

HOW LONG CAN YOU WORK ON MAKING A ROUTINE TASK MORE EFFICIENT BEFORE YOU'RE SPENDING MORE TIME THAN YOU SAVE?
(ACROSS FIVE YEARS)

		HOW OFTEN YOU DO THE TASK					
		50/DAY	5/DAY	DAILY	WEEKLY	MONTHLY	YEARLY
HOW MUCH TIME YOU SHAVE OFF	1 SECOND	1 DAY	2 HOURS	30 MINUTES	4 MINUTES	1 MINUTE	5 SECONDS
	5 SECONDS	5 DAYS	12 HOURS	2 HOURS	21 MINUTES	5 MINUTES	25 SECONDS
	30 SECONDS	4 WEEKS	3 DAYS	12 HOURS	2 HOURS	30 MINUTES	2 MINUTES
	1 MINUTE	8 WEEKS	6 DAYS	1 DAY	4 HOURS	1 HOUR	5 MINUTES
	5 MINUTES	9 MONTHS	4 WEEKS	6 DAYS	21 HOURS	5 HOURS	25 MINUTES
	30 MINUTES		6 MONTHS	5 WEEKS	5 DAYS	1 DAY	2 HOURS
	1 HOUR		10 MONTHS	2 MONTHS	10 DAYS	2 DAYS	5 HOURS
	6 HOURS				2 MONTHS	2 WEEKS	1 DAY
	1 DAY					8 WEEKS	5 DAYS

💡 AI and Automated Data Extraction

Automated data extraction is a rapidly changing field due to advances in machine learning and other 'AI' tools. The list below will be changing frequently to reflect these advances, but working through some of these methods by hand is an excellent way to evaluate what these tools can and can't do for your research.

15.1. APIs

1. Isabella Velásquez: Creating APIs for Data Science With `plumber`: [\[link\]](#) (and the link to the `plumber` package)
2. SESYNC: Data APIs in R Lesson [\[link\]](#)
3. The Carpentries: APIs with R [\[link\]](#)
4. Md Sakhawat Hossen: Working with the APIs (Application Programming Interfaces) in R [\[link\]](#)

15.2. Optical Character Recognition

1. Video Primer: [What is OCR?](#)

Online OCR Tools (text & data from .pdf to .csv, .txt, etc.)

1. Google Drive - Video Primer: [OCR with Google Drive](#)
2. Free online sites for small batches (can upgrade for larger numbers of files)
 - [Free Online OCR 1](#)
 - [New OCR](#)
 - [pdf to excel](#)
 - [OnlineOCR](#)
 - [PDFTables](#) will convert PDF to .csv, and has an [API](#) so you can do your conversions in bulk with R. You can do ~25 pages free; large numbers are reasonably priced.
3. [Amazon TextExtract](#)
4. [Mathpix Snip](#) digitizes handwritten or printed text, and copies outputs to the clipboard that can be pasted into LaTeX editors like Overleaf, Markdown editors like Typora, Microsoft Word, and more.

OCR with R

1. R package `pdftools`
2. R package `tabulapdf`
3. Detailed [Blog Post & Tutorial](#)
4. Other Written Tutorials: [tutorial 1](#), [tutorial 2](#), [tutorial 3](#)
5. Video Tutorials: [Video Tutorial 1](#), [Video Tutorial 2](#)
6. [Convert PDF to text in R - OCR pdftools](#)
7. [PDFtools in R](#)
8. More advanced but more powerful from the Programming Historian: [OCR with Google Vision API and Tesseract](#)

15.3. Extracting tables from images with R

1. R package [magick](#) (*this package actually includes several very powerful tools for image processing; this is just one of the things you can do with it*)
2. Detailed [Blog Post](#) / [Tutorial](#)

15.4. Extracting Data from Published Figures

1. Ankit Rohagni's [Web Plot Digitizer](#)
 - WPD [Video Tutorial](#)
 - WPD Tutorial [Blog Post](#)
2. Alternative 1: R package [magick](#)
3. Alternative 2: [GetData](#) extracts data automatically from scanned images (~\$30).
4. Alternative 3: R package [digitize](#) will extract data from scatterplots within the R environment. *Note that this is no longer on CRAN due to dependency issues but you can still install and try to work with it directly from the Github repository.*
5. A more comprehensive overview: Brauckhoff, et al., "Exploring Image Analysis in R: Applications and Advancements", The R Journal, 2025 [\[link\]](#)

15.5. Text Mining

1. [Text Mining with R](#) by Julia Silge and David Robinson
2. [gutenbergr](#): Download and Process Public Domain Works from [Project Gutenberg](#). Tutorial can be found [here](#)

Useful reading on text mining

1. Atanassova I, Bertin M and Mayr P (2019) Editorial: Mining Scientific Papers: NLP-enhanced Bibliometrics. Front. Res. Metr. Anal. 4:2. doi: [10.3389/frma.2019.00002](#)
2. Westergaard D, Stærfeldt H-H, Tønsberg C, Jensen LJ, Brunak S (2018) A comprehensive and quantitative comparison of text-mining in 15 million full-text articles versus their corresponding abstracts. PLoS Comput Biol 14(2): e1005962. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pcbi.1005962>
3. Salloum, S.A., Al-Emran, M., Monem, A.A., Shaalan, K. (2018). Using Text Mining Techniques for Extracting Information from Research Articles. In: Shaalan, K., Hassanien, A., Tolba, F. (eds) Intelligent Natural Language Processing: Trends and Applications. Studies in Computational Intelligence, vol 740. Springer, Cham. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-67056-0_18

4. Simon, C., Davidsen, K., Hansen, C. et al. BioReader: a text mining tool for performing classification of biomedical literature. BMC Bioinformatics 19, 57 (2019). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12859-019-2607-x>
5. Benchimol, J., Kazinnik, S., & Saadon, Y. (2022). Text mining methodologies with R: An application to central bank texts. Machine Learning with Applications, 8, 100286.[link](#)
6. Yu, C., Zhang, C., & Wang, J. (2020). Extracting Body Text from Academic PDF Documents for Text Mining. Proceedings of the 12th International Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Information Retrieval (KDIR 2020). <https://www.scitepress.org/Papers/2020/101314/101314.pdf>
7. Gulo, C. A., & Rúbio, T. R. (2015, January). Text Mining Scientific Articles using the R. In Doctoral Symposium in Informatics Engineering. [link](#)

15.6. Collecting & Processing data from the Web of Science and Scopus

1. R package [refsplitr](#)
2. R package [bibliometrix](#)
3. [jstor: An R package for Analysing Scientific Articles](#) and link to [JSTORr package repository](#) on Github. *The package is no longer on CRAN but you may still find it useful to browse the repo.*

15.7. Scraping websites

1. Library Carpentry [Lesson on Webscraping](#) *Note: no longer updated and a bit out of date, but still a very useful introduction*
2. Start Here: [Introduction to webscraping](#)
3. Video: [Scraping WebData in R with rvest](#)
4. Video: [Practical Introduction to Web Scraping using R](#)
5. Very nice [written tutorial](#)...
6.and another one, this time from the [UC Business Analytics R Programming Guide](#)
7. [SelectorGadget](#) is useful to id CSS selectors.
8. Noortje Marres & Esther Weltevrede (2013) Scraping the Social?, Journal of Cultural Economy, 6:3, 313-335, DOI:10.1080/17530350.2013.772070

15.8. Cell Phone Data

1. Exploratory analyses [Part 1](#) and [Part 2](#)

15.9. Social Media Data

1. How to extract Biodiversity Data from Facebook: Chowdhury, S., Ahmed, S., Alam, S., Callaghan, C. T., Das, P., Di Marco, M., Di Minin, E., Jarić, I., Labi, M. M., Rokonuzzaman, Md., Roll, U., Sbragaglia, V., Siddika, A., & Bonn, A. (2024). A protocol for harvesting biodiversity data from Facebook. *Conservation Biology*, 38, e14257. <https://doi.org/10.1111/cobi.14257>
2. Di Minin, E., Fink, C., Hausmann, A., Kremer, J. and Kulkarni, R. (2021), How to address data privacy concerns when using social media data in conservation science. *Conservation Biology*, 35: 437-446. <https://doi.org/10.1111/cobi.13708>
3. Correia, R.A., Ladle, R., Jarić, I., Malhado, A.C.M., Mittermeier, J.C., Roll, U., Soriano-Redondo, A., Veríssimo, D., Fink, C., Hausmann, A., Guedes-Santos, J., Vardi, R. and Di Minin, E. (2021), Digital data sources and methods for conservation culturomics. *Conservation Biology*, 35: 398-411. <https://doi.org/10.1111/cobi.13706>
4. Fox, Nathan, Tom August, Francesca Mancini, Katherine E. Parks, Felix Eigenbrod, James M. Bullock, Louis Sutter, and Laura J. Graham. ““photosearcher” package in R: An accessible and reproducible method for harvesting large datasets from Flickr.” *SoftwareX* 12 (2020): 100624. <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S235271102030337X>
5. Ergon Cugler de Moraes Silva: TelegramScrap: A comprehensive tool for scraping Telegram data. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2412.16786>
6. Batrinca, B., Treleaven, P.C. Social media analytics: a survey of techniques, tools and platforms. *AI & Soc* 30, 89–116 (2015). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s00146-014-0549-4>

15.10. Automated Image Analysis

1. Pennekamp, F. and Schtickzelle, N. (2013), Implementing image analysis in laboratory-based experimental systems for ecology and evolution: a hands-on guide. *Methods Ecol Evol*, 4: 483-492. <https://doi.org/10.1111/2041-210X.12036>
2. How to build your own image recognition app with R! [Part 1](#) and [Part 2](#)
3. LinkedIn Learning Course: [Deep Learning - Image Recognition](#) requires UF login
4. [UF Practicum AI courses](#) include one on Image recognition models.

15.11. Wearable Devices & RFID tags

1. [What is an RFID tag?](#)
2. Rafiq, K., Appleby, R. G., Edgar, J. P., Radford, C., Smith, B. P., Jordan, N. R., Dexter, C. E., Jones, D. N., Blacker, A. R. F., & Cochrane, M. (2021). WildWID: An open-source active RFID system for wildlife research. *Methods in Ecology and Evolution*, 12, 1580– 1587. <https://doi.org/10.1111/2041-210X.13651>

3. [Build your own RFID device](#)
4. Izmailova, E.S., Wagner, J.A. and Perakslis, E.D. (2018), Wearable Devices in Clinical Trials: Hype and Hypothesis. *Clin. Pharmacol. Ther.*, 104: 42-52. <https://doi.org/10.1002/cpt.966>
5. Loncar-Turukalo T, Zdravevski E, Machado da Silva J, Chouvarda I, Trajkovik V. Literature on Wearable Technology for Connected Health: Scoping Review of Research Trends, Advances, and Barriers *J Med Internet Res* 2019;21(9):e14017 [doi: 10.2196/14017](https://doi.org/10.2196/14017)
6. [Why Should Sociologists Care about Wearable Tech?](#)
7. Harari, G. M., Lane, N. D., Wang, R., Crosier, B. S., Campbell, A. T., & Gosling, S. D. (2016). Using Smartphones to Collect Behavioral Data in Psychological Science: Opportunities, Practical Considerations, and Challenges. *Perspectives on Psychological Science* 11(6), 838-854 <https://doi.org/10.1177/1745691616650285>
8. Seifert Alexander, Hofer Matthias, Allemand Mathias. 2018. Mobile Data Collection: Smart, but Not (Yet) Smart Enough. 12. *Frontiers in Neuroscience* <https://www.frontiersin.org/article/10.3389/fnins.2018.00971>

15.12. Building automated data collectors

1. Calipers that dump data directly to Excel [link](#)
2. Morris BI, Kittredge MJ, Casey B, Meng O, Chagas AM, Lamparter M, et al. (2022) PiSpy: An affordable, accessible, and flexible imaging platform for the automated observation of organismal biology and behavior. *PLoS ONE* 17(10): e0276652. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0276652>
3. Jolles, J. W. (2021). Broad-scale applications of the Raspberry Pi: A review and guide for biologists. *Methods in Ecology and Evolution*, 12, 1562– 1579. <https://doi.org/10.1111/2041-210X.13652>

15.13. Online data archives

Overview: Correia, R.A., Ladle, R., Jarić, I., Malhado, A.C.M., Mittermeier, J.C., Roll, U., Soriano-Redondo, A., Veríssimo, D., Fink, C., Hausmann, A., Guedes-Santos, J., Vardi, R. and Di Minin, E. (2021), Digital data sources and methods for conservation culturomics. *Conservation Biology*, 35: 398-411. <https://doi.org/10.1111/cobi.13706>

Government data

1. [Data.gov](#) (the open data portal of the US Government) and [Using Data.gov APIs in R](#)
2. the [rOpengov Project](#)
3. [Open Fiscal Data Package](#)
4. [educationdata](#): Retrieve data from the Urban Institute's Education Data API as a `data.frame` for easy analysis. See [also here](#)
5. a [huge list](#) of data sources for social scientists available with R tools
6. accessing [World bank Data](#) with R

US & World Census Data

1. [A Guide to Working with US Census Data in R](#)
2. R Package [tidycensus](#)
3. [Tutorial 1](#)
4. [Tutorial 2](#)
5. R package [ipumsr](#): The `ipumsr` package helps import IPUMS extracts from the IPUMS website into R. IPUMS provides census and survey data from around the world integrated across time and space.

Education Data

1. [edbuildr](#): import [EdBuild's master dataset](#) of school district finance, student demographics, and community economic indicators for every school district in the United States.
2. [Building R and Stata packages for the Education Data Portal](#)

Other Online Data Portals

1. Giant [compendium of open datasets #1](#)
2. [Data on Amazonia](#)
3. R package [bdc](#): toolkit for gathering & cleaning biodiversity data

Software for gathering data from online archives

1. [EcoRetriever](#): automates the tasks of finding, downloading, and cleaning up publicly available ecological data, and then stores them in a local database or csv files.
2. [litsearcher](#) an R package to facilitate quasi-automatic search strategy development for systematic review

16. Ethics & Legal Compliance

16.1. Data/Research Ethics & Compliance for UF Researchers

1. [UF Research Misconduct Homepage](#): Policy, Training, Reporting, and Best Practices
2. [UF Office of Research Integrity and Compliance](#) (Research Integrity & Compliance)
3. Info for UF Researchers regarding [Risk Assessment for International Collaborations and Export Control](#)
4. [UF IACUC](#)
5. [UF IRB](#)
6. [UF Privacy Office](#)

16.2. Privacy Laws

1. CDC: [what is HIPPA?](#)
2. Global Privacy Laws, including the EU General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)? ([link 1](#)), ([link 2](#)), ([link 3 - UF](#))
3. What is [FERPA](#)?

16.3. Anonymizing Data

Overview

1. UK Data Service Webinar: [How to anonymise qualitative and quantitative data](#)
2. [Intro to Anonymization](#)
3. [Overview by Martin Monkman](#)
4. [EDUCASE Guidelines for Data De-Identification or Anonymization](#)
5. [UF “HOW TO: DE-IDENTIFY DATA”](#), with very useful **checklists**

Tools for Anonymizing Data Overview

Tip with Title

Anymizing data is difficult and the consequences for failing to do so can be severe. Be *very* careful - or better still, seek guidance from experts on campus.

Anonymizing with R

1. Martin Monkman's link to [R packages for Anonymizing Data](#)
2. Blog Post / [Tutorial](#)
3. R package [Anonymizer](#)
4. Anonymizing in R: [part 1](#) and [part 2](#)

Stand-alone software and online tools for anonymizing

1. [list of free tools](#)
2. [ARX](#) (open source, free)
3. [Amnesia](#) (open source, free)
4. De-identification Tools from [NIST](#)
5. [AirCloak](#) (paid)

16.4. Working with Indigenous Communities

1. [Indigenous peoples and responsible data: an introductory reading list](#)
2. [CARE Principles for Indigenous Data Governance](#)
3. Carroll, S.R., Herczog, E., Hudson, M. et al. Operationalizing the CARE and FAIR Principles for Indigenous data futures. *Sci Data* 8, 108 (2021). <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41597-021-00892-0>

16.5. Data Collection, Privacy, and Gender

1. [How to Ethically and Responsibly Identify Gender in Large Datasets](#)
2. Clair A Kronk et al. 2022. Transgender data collection in the electronic health record: Current concepts and issues. *Journal of the American Medical Informatics Association* 29(2):271–284 <https://doi.org/10.1093/jamia/ocab136>
3. Heidari, S. et al. 2016. Sex and Gender Equity in Research: rationale for the SAGER guidelines and recommended use. *Res Integr Peer Rev* 1,2 (2016). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s41073-016-0007-6>
4. The European Institute for Gender Equality's [GEAR Tool](#) (Gender Equality in Academia and Research)
5. UN "Methods for gender data collection and estimation" [Training Materials](#).
6. Colaço, R., and Watson-Grant, S. (2021). A Global Call to Action for Gender-Inclusive Data Collection and Use. RTI Press Publication No. PB-0026-2112. Research Triangle Park, NC: RTI Press. <https://doi.org/10.3768/rtpress.2021.pb.0026.2112>

16.6. Emerging issues resulting from technological advancements

1. [Automated Data Collection: The Big Picture and Legal Issues](#)
2. [Are transcription services HIPPA compliant?](#)
3. Di Minin, E. et al. 2021. How to address data privacy concerns when using social media data in conservation science. *Conservation Biology*, 35:437-446. <https://doi.org/10.1111/cobi.13708>

16.7. Text mining, copyright, and the law

1. [Text and Data Mining of In-Copyright Works: Is It Legal?](#)
2. [The plan to mine the world's research papers](#)
3. [Copyright and the Progress of Science: Why Text and Data Mining Is Lawful](#)
4. [Copyright's impact on data mining in academic research](#)
5. [Text and Data Mining at Springer Nature](#)
6. UF Library Guide: [Copyright on Campus: Essentials](#)
7. UF Library Guide: [Data Sharing & Copyright](#)

16.8. Ethics of Data Sharing

1. [Commit to transparent COVID data until the WHO declares the pandemic is over](#)
2. [NIH issues a seismic mandate: share data publicly](#)

Part II.

Individual Projects

17. Assignments Overview

Grades in the course will be based on the following assignments:

17.1. Weekly In-class activities

- **Overview:** Most of the in-class assignments involve hands-on practice with data collection or manipulation. In some weeks, however, assignment will be the submission of questions for group discussion or brief reflection on the issues from the readings. Most in-class assignments are designed to be completed during the class session, but to ensure students master the concepts rather than rush through them *they can be submitted anytime until 9 am the following Friday.*

17.2. Reproducible Data Organization Project

- **Overview:** This project is an opportunity to put some of the lessons learned into practice with a data set of your own. Your assignment is to (1) clean and organize a ‘messy’ data set and prepare metadata describing the resulting ‘clean’ data. The complete project requires the submission of these three items via the course Canvas website:
 - (1) R code that imports, cleans, and organizes, and saves ‘messy’ data
 - (2) The resulting corrected and organized data in an appropriate format
 - (3) Metadata describing the corrected data set

17.3. Thesis Research DMP

- **Overview:** The Data Management Plan (DMP) is a critical document describing the data to be collected for a research project, how it will be stored and managed, and the investigator with primary responsibility for its management. Many funding agencies, including NSF and NIH, now require a DMP with all grant applications. Each student will prepare a Data Management Plan (DMP) for their thesis research.

Part III.

Useful Resources

18. Useful resources for Data Collection & Managment

18.1. R Programming

Essential Resources

1. ***R for Data Science* book:** Hadley Wickham wrote a book on using the tidyverse and *the online version is FREE*. This is a phenomenal resource on using R to import, tidy, and visualize data.
2. **Posit Cheat Sheets:** help with commands for using the different `tidyverse` packages, RStudio shortcuts and tricks, help with R commands, and more. You definitely want the ones for Data Import, Work with Strings, Factors, Data Transformation, and Base R.
3. **RStudio Keyboard Shortcuts:** A list of the keyboard shortcuts for Mac, Windows, and Linux can be found [here](#).
4. **Where and How to ask for help:**
 - Hadley Wickham's advice on [how to write a good reproducible example](#) for getting help with R
 - [how to post good questions on StackOverflow](#)
 - The UF [R-users listserv](#) is *very* user friendly and a great place to post requests for help.

Tutorials

1. [Paul van der Laken's List](#) of books, tutorials, and other resources on topics ranging from data manipulation to data validation to data visualization.
2. [R Essential Training: Wrangling and Visualizing Data](#). (requires a UF email address to access LinkedIn Learning).
3. Software Carpentry: [Using RStudio for Project Organization & Management](#)
4. [Swirl](#): learn R programming interactively, at your own pace, and in the R console.
5. [R Bootcamp](#) by Ted Laderas and Jessica Minnier. Learn R in your browser.
6. [How to clean messy data in R](#)

7. [The Ultimate Guide to Data Cleaning](#) is written for Python users but the principles apply regardless of language.

18.2. Specific Data Cleaning and Management Problems

Dates & Times

1. [Handling dates and times in R](#)

Text & Text Mining

2. Text Mining: [tidytext](#) package

Qualtrics

3. Working with Qualtrics survey data: [qualtRics](#) package

Text Extraction

4. Optical Character Recognition (OCR): extract text from images: [tesseract](#) package
5. Extract text & metadata from pdf files: [pdftools](#) package

Images & Image Processing

6. Image processing: the [magick](#) package

18.3. Advanced R Packages for Data Management

1. [DataCurator](#) package: ‘a simple desktop data editor to help describe, validate and share usable open data’.
2. [RegExpr](#): online tool to learn, build, & test Regular Expressions (RegEx / RegExp)
3. [janitor](#) (cleanup of file names, etc.)
4. [ROpenSci](#): tools for accessing, manipulating, and visualizing open data

18.4. Data Visualization

1. [Data Visualization: a practical introduction](#) by Kieran Healy is my favorite introductory (yet super-comprehensive) book on data visualization with R. If you scroll down to the bottom of the page you can download the datasets and code used to make the figures in the book, which makes life much easier.

18.5. Slide & Presentations

1. Make [slide presentations with R](#)

18.6. Documents & Reports

1. [knitr](#) overview: reproducible documents with R

18.7. Discipline-specific R Resources

History

1. [historydata](#) package: Sample data sets for historians learning R. They include population, institutional, religious, military, and prosopographical data suitable for mapping, quantitative analysis, and network analysis.
2. [The Programming Historian](#) Website: wide range of topics, from text analysis to OpenRefine

Psychology

1. [‘Programming for Psychologists: Data Creation and Analysis’](#) by Matthew J. C. Crump

18.8. Data Archives

1. [Qualitative Data Repository](#): dedicated archive for storing and sharing digital data (and accompanying documentation) generated or collected through qualitative and multi-method research in the social sciences and related disciplines.
2. [Data Dryad](#): open data publishing platform and a community committed to the open availability and routine re-use of all research data.
3. [ICPSR](#): data access, curation, and analytical methods for social science.

18.9. Disposal & Destruction of Records

1. UF IT: [Securely Destroying Electronic and Paper Records](#)
2. UF Procurement Services: [Approved vendors for document destruction services](#)
3. UF Approved Methods for [Electronic Media Disposal](#)

18.10. Non-R software & tools

Linguistics

1. [lameta](#): tool for organizing collections of files and metadatata made in the course of documenting language, music, and other cultural expressions.
2. [FieldWorks Language Explorer](#): Dictionary Creation Software; comprehensive tool that allows you to create a dictionary for a language by collecting texts, words, and cultural information. It is widely used for documenting and preserving low-resource languages and cultures.

18.10.1. Text analysis

{AntConc}(<https://www.laurenceanthony.net/software.html>): A freeware corpus analysis toolkit for concordancing and text analysis (see link for related tools); a tutorial from the Programming Historian [is available here](#).

19. Class Slides

The following slides are available in HTML format You can export them as PDFs by clicking on the three bars in the bottom left corner and selecting “PDF Export Mode” under the “Tools” Option.

1. [Introduction](#)
2. [Data Organization and Backups](#)
3. [‘Reproducible’ Data Management](#)
4. [QA/QC 1 - Error Minimization](#)
5. [Data Management Plans](#)
6. [Efficient Data Collection & Form Design](#)
7. [Transcription & Translation](#)